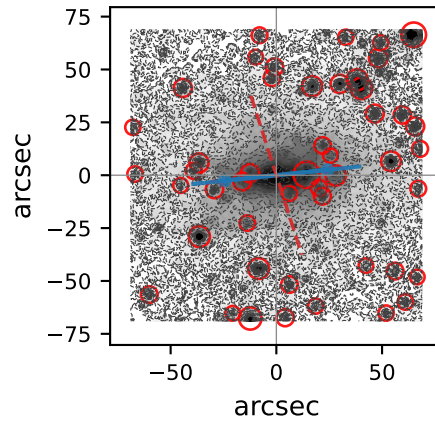
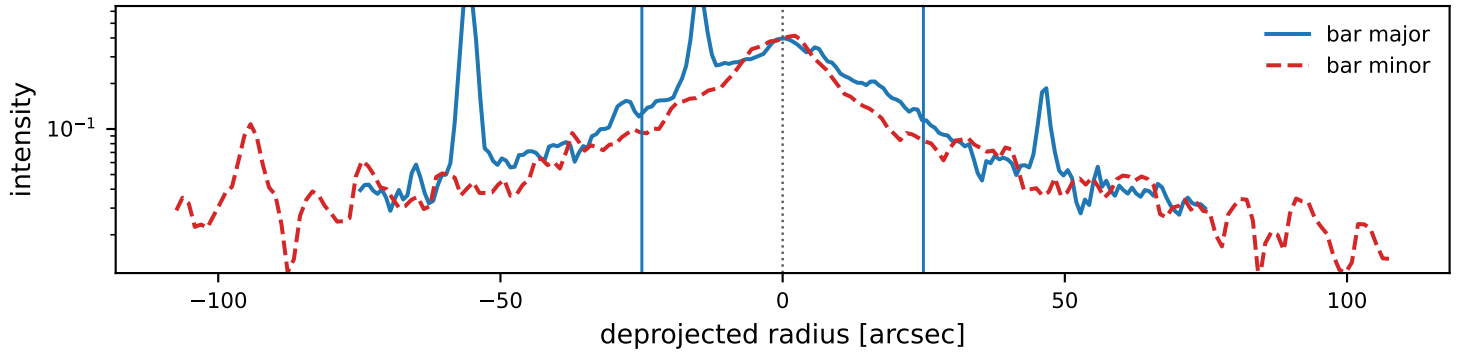


ESO120-012 foreground-mask profile comparison bar PA=96.0 deg

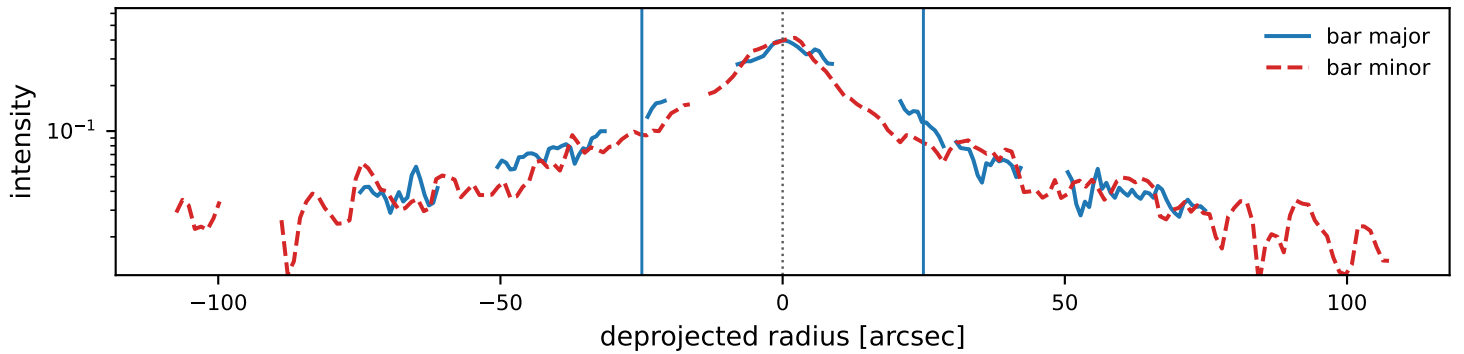
S4G 3.6 micron isophotes with masked objects circled



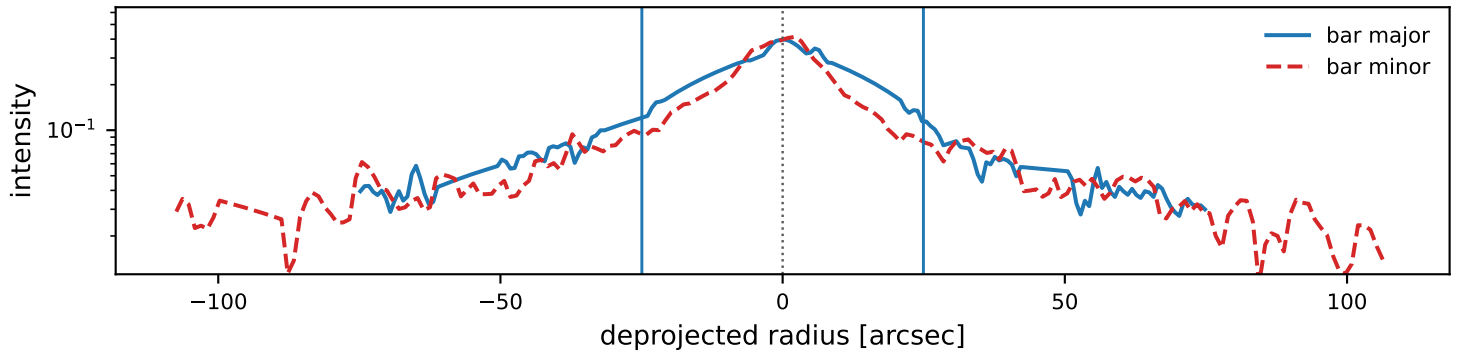
Original major/minor-axis cuts



Masked major/minor-axis cuts



Masked cuts with interpolated gaps



Parameter	Value
Masking model	photutils segmentation on residual image; photutils 3.0.0
Residual image	science image - Gaussian-smoothed galaxy model
Detection threshold	3.5 sigma above residual median
Smooth sigma	15 px
Connected-pixel minimum	8 px
Dilation radius	3 px
Max segment area	500 px
Max elongation	6
Central exclusion radius	12 px
Profile width	3 px
Applied mask	615 source segments; 52889 pixels ignored
Interpolated panel	linear interpolation across masked/non-positive profile gaps